Case 14: "Probation review: postponed. Again." (unfair dismissal after 6 months, from 1 Jan 2027)

7 Oct 2026 · Short 06 (Employment: probation review) · retention format (engine v3) · colour per section
Spec: 1:15 · 1080×1920 · 30 fps · sound-off captions burned in · silent AAC track for VO
Video: `videos/dogetlawyer_case-file-14_1080x1920.mp4` · Renderer: `tools/render_case14.py` · Thumbnails: `thumbnails/case-14_*`
Look: Navy & steel (hook) → burnt umber (the change) → teal slate (3 things) → deep indigo (key dates) → back to navy & steel. League Gothic / Work Sans / Overpass Mono / Literata italic.

Hook and thumbnail





Frame 0: a diary with three crossed-out "Probation review: Sam" entries and a red POSTPONED AGAIN stamp + PROBATION REVIEW: POSTPONED. AGAIN. → 0:03 THEY CAN CLAIM AFTER: "2 YEARS" struck out → 6 MONTHS. → 0:07 AND YOUR PROBATION CLAUSE WON'T CHANGE THAT. Thumbnail: glowing 6 MONTHS + red banner NOT 2 YEARS + the POSTPONED diary + an alarm-clock emoji.

Voiceover, clean read

You've postponed Sam's probation review. Again. From the first of January, staff can claim unfair dismissal after six months. Not two years. And a probation clause in their contract won't change that. That's the government's own wording. The qualifying period drops from two years to six months, for dismissals from the first of January. And it counts staff you've already got. Anyone who started by the first of July this year will already have six months' service. And the cap on compensation for unfair dismissal is being removed too. So that review you keep moving? It really matters now. Here's what to do. One. Put every probation end date in the diary, with a named owner and a reminder well before month six. Two. Actually hold the review, and write it down. What was discussed, what was agreed, and the outcome. Three. Check what the contract says. How long probation is, whether it can be extended, and the notice period. Dogetlawyer keeps every contract in one place, with key dates like probation end dates, and a task with a name against each one. Be honest. How many times have you moved a probation review? Comment it. Stop postponing. Six months comes round fast. Dogetlawyer dot com, link in bio.

Timeline

Time	Section	Colour	Voiceover
0:00–0:03	Postponed	Hook · navy & steel	You've postponed Sam's probation review. Again.
0:03–0:07	Postponed	Hook · navy & steel	From the first of January, staff can claim unfair dismissal after six months. Not two years.
0:07–0:10	Postponed	Hook · navy & steel	And a probation clause in their contract won't change that.
0:10–0:17	The Change	The change · burnt umber	That's the government's own wording. The qualifying period drops from two years to six months, for dismissals from the first of January.
0:17–0:23	The Change	The change · burnt umber	And it counts staff you've already got. Anyone who started by the first of July this year will already have six months' service.
0:23–0:29	The Change	The change · burnt umber	And the cap on compensation for unfair dismissal is being removed too.
0:29–0:33	The Change	The change · burnt umber	So that review you keep moving? It really matters now.
0:33–0:36	3 Things	3 things · teal slate	Here's what to do.
0:36–0:43	Step 1	3 things · teal slate	One. Put every probation end date in the diary, with a named owner and a reminder well before month six.
0:43–0:50	Step 2	3 things · teal slate	Two. Actually hold the review, and write it down. What was discussed, what was agreed, and the outcome.
0:50–0:57	Step 3	3 things · teal slate	Three. Check what the contract says. How long probation is, whether it can be extended, and the notice period.
0:57–1:05	Key Dates	Key dates · deep indigo	Dogetlawyer keeps every contract in one place, with key dates like probation end dates, and a task with a name against each one.
1:05–1:10	Your Turn	Hook · navy & steel	Be honest. How many times have you moved a probation review? Comment it.
1:10–1:15	Dogetlawyer	Hook · navy & steel	Stop postponing. Six months comes round fast. Dogetlawyer dot com, link in bio.

Title, description, tags

- Title: 6 Months, Not 2 Years: The Unfair Dismissal Change Coming 1 January
- Alt title: Keep Postponing Probation Reviews? Read This Before 1 January 2027
- Pinned comment: How many times have you moved a probation review? 0, 1, 2 or 3+?

Keep postponing that probation review? From 1 January 2027, the qualifying period for ordinary unfair dismissal drops from 2 years to 6 months, and a probation clause in the contract doesn't change that. Anyone who started by 1 July 2026 will already have six months' service, and the cap on compensatory awards is being removed.

3 things to do before 1 January:
1. Diarise every probation end date, with a named owner and an early reminder
2. Hold the review and write it down: what was discussed, agreed and the outcome
3. Check the contract: probation length, extension wording, notice period

→ Keep every contract and key date in one place at dogetlawyer.com (link in bio)

0:00 Postponed again · 0:03 6 months, not 2 years · 0:10 The government's wording · 0:17 Staff you already have · 0:23 No cap on compensation · 0:33 3 things to do · 0:57 Key dates · 1:05 Your turn

Sources: Business.gov.uk, "Unfair dismissal rights"; GOV.UK, Plan to Make Work Pay and Employment Rights Act timeline (reduction to 6 months for dismissals from 1 January 2027, and uncapping compensatory awards); GOV.UK unfair dismissal factsheet. Applies in England, Scotland and Wales. General position; outcomes turn on the facts. All names and dates shown are fictional examples. Dogetlawyer is contract management software for UK small businesses, not a substitute for legal advice.

#smallbusinessuk #employmentlaw #probation #unfairdismissal #ukemployer #hr #employmentrightsact

Tags: probation period UK, probation review, unfair dismissal 6 months, unfair dismissal qualifying period 2027, Employment Rights Act 2025, 1 January 2027, employer guide UK, HR small business, probation clause

SEO keywords

Keyword	Where
probation review	Hook; steps; title; thumbnail
unfair dismissal 6 months	0:03; 0:10 quote; title; thumbnail
1 January 2027	Hook 0:03; 0:10; description
probation clause	0:07; step 3
Employment Rights Act 2025	Tags, description

Compliance notes

- Rule 4 held: information only; no "compliance engine" or automated probation protection. The product is shown holding probation end dates with a task and a named owner.
- Law verified on business.gov.uk and GOV.UK (6 months, for dismissals from 1 January 2027; uncapped compensatory awards), quoted verbatim; "ordinary" unfair dismissal named; GB only.
- No statistics; no prices or offers; employee names and dates are fictional and labelled; standard fine print on the close.